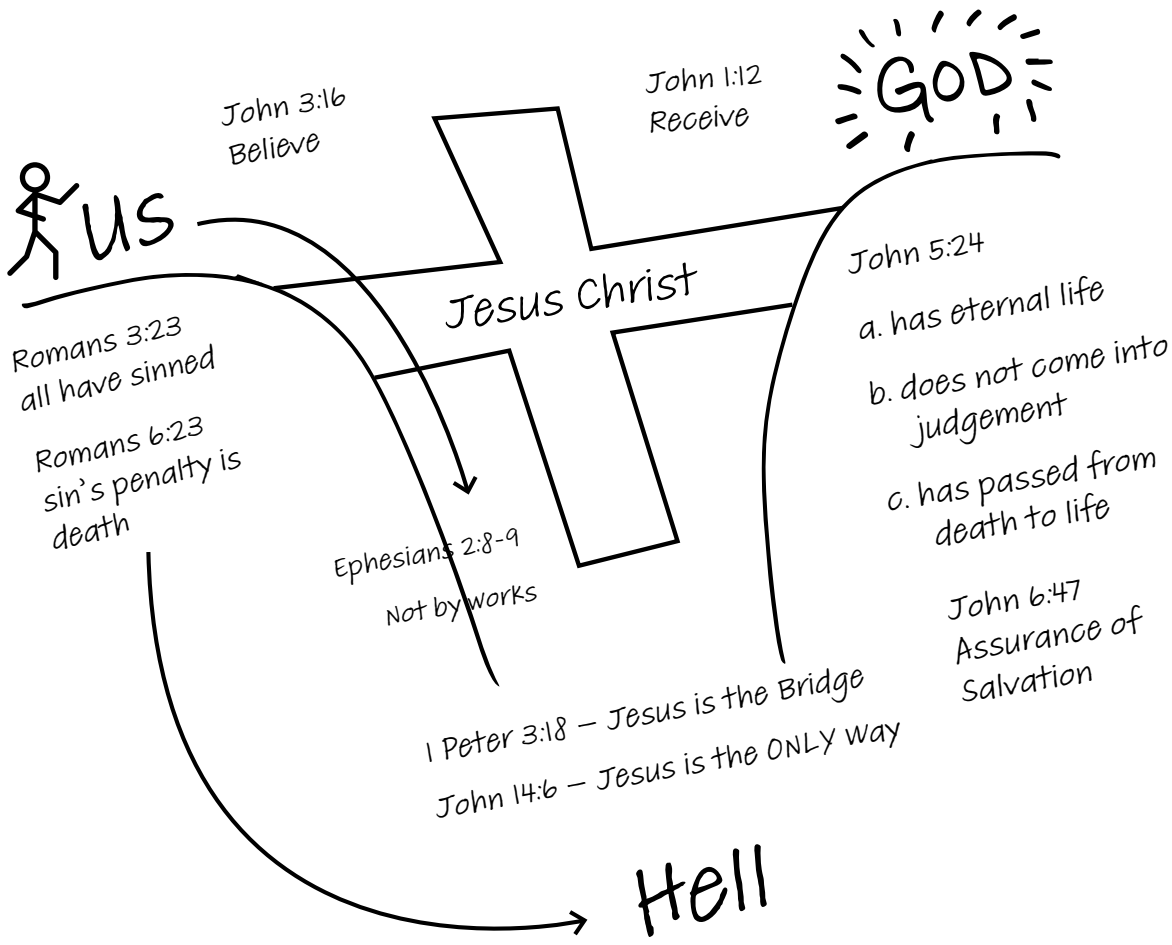
UNION CHURCH
OF MANILA

God's Story:
A Gospel-Sharing Tool



The Bridge Illustration:
"The Bridge" uses a simple way to share the gospel message using illustration, showing there is no intermediary to God except Jesus. Every Scripture verse cited fits in the context of its intended meaning in the bible.

There are plenty of great sermons or teachings out there exhorting Christians to evangelize or to witness, yet the vast majority remain unmoved. Based on studies, only one out of 10 Christians make a genuine effort to share the gospel with others; there might be several reasons for this, but here are two main ones:

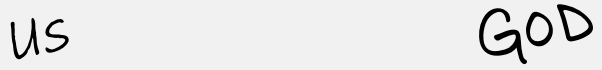
1 Basically, some believe that the believers' presence is enough, that it is enough to show through one's life the goodness of God. Indeed, presence is essential. But this will not provide adequate information to lead a person to saving faith in Christ. The apostle Paul pointed out, "How then will they call on him in whom they have not believed? And how are they to believe in him of whom they have never heard? And how are they to hear without someone preaching?" (Romans 10:14). Proclamation of the gospel is needed to lead the lost to Jesus Christ.

2 Many Christians simply don't know how to share the good news of salvation.

Step 1

Ⓐ **WE MATTER TO GOD. He made us, and He wants to have a relationship with us.**

Ⓑ Write "Us" on the left side of the paper and "God" on the right side.

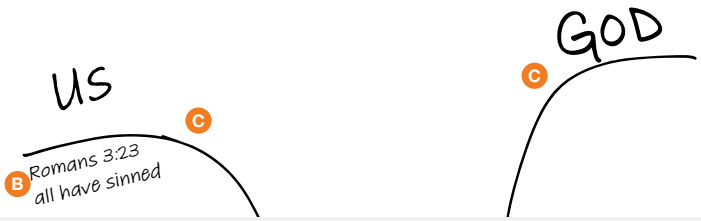


Step 2

Ⓐ **HOWEVER, we have rebelled against God and disobeyed Him. Romans 3:23 says, "for all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God." Our sins have separated us from God and broken off the relationship.**

Ⓑ Write Romans 3:23 and "all have sinned" under Us.

Ⓒ Draw lines by both "Us" and "God" in such a way that they form walls around a giant chasm, separating us from God.



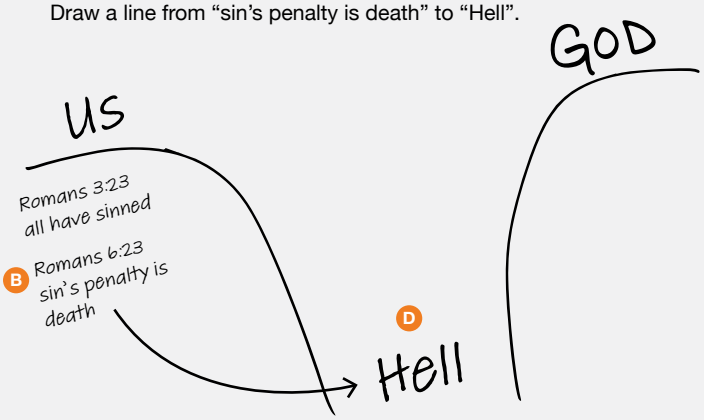
Step 3

Ⓐ **FURTHERMORE, the sins we have committed must be penalized. The penalty owed is death. Romans 6:23 says, "For the wages of sin is death, but the free gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord."**

Ⓒ **Death in the Bible means physical and spiritual death, which means separation from God for eternity in Hell.**

Ⓑ Write Romans 6:23 and "sin's penalty is death"

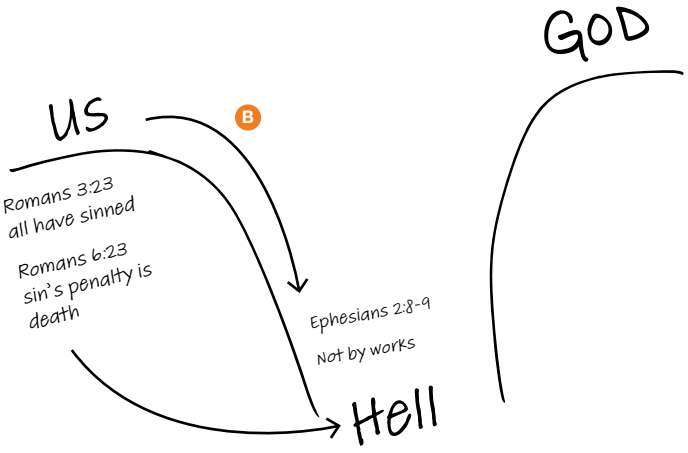
Ⓓ Write "Hell" at the bottom of the chasm.
Draw a line from "sin's penalty is death" to "Hell".



Step 4

Ⓐ **TO VARYING DEGREES, most of us are aware of our distance from God, so we start doing all kinds of things, like being charitable, going to church, and making sacrifices to get back to God. These are commendable things, but the Bible clarifies that none can earn us God's forgiveness or re-establish our relationship with Him. Ephesians 2:8-9 says, "For by grace you have been saved through faith. And this is not your own doing; it is the gift of God, not a result of works, so that no one may boast."**

Ⓑ Draw an arrow going over the "Us" cliff.
This signifies our attempts to reach God that always fall short.
Write "Ephesians 2:8-9" and "not by works"



Step 5

A IT LOOKS PRETTY HOPELESS, but the good news is that we matter to God. In fact, God loves us so much that he did for us what we can never do for ourselves. He provided a "bridge" over which we can find His forgiveness and restore our relationship with Him.

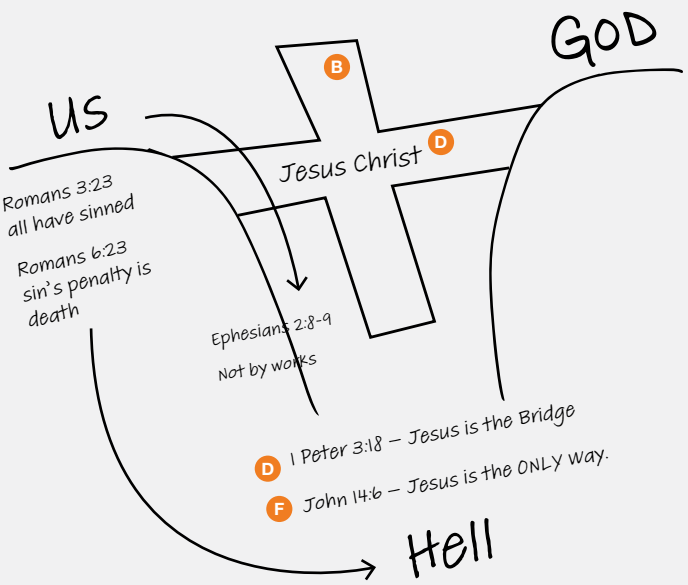
B Draw a cross so that it touches both sides of the chasm.

C He built it by coming to earth as one of us and dying on the cross to pay the death penalty we owed. 1 Peter 3:18 says, "For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh but made alive in the spirit."

D Write "1 Peter 3:18 – Jesus is the Bridge" directly under the cross, and write "Jesus Christ" on the cross.

E The Bible also clearly says that Jesus is the ONLY bridge back to God. In John 14:6, "*Jesus* said... "I am the way, and the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me."

F Write below 1 Peter 3:18, "John 14:6 – Jesus is the ONLY Way."



Step 6

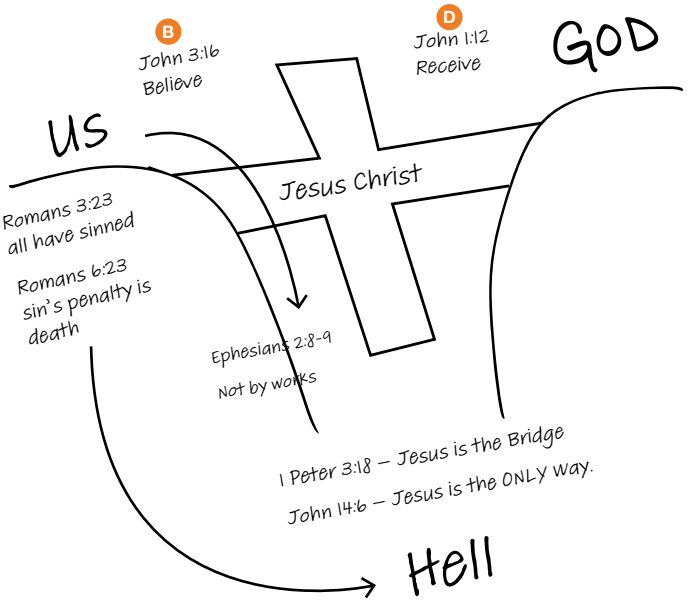
A THIS IS A PICTURE OF WHAT THE CENTRAL MESSAGE OF THE BIBLE IS ALL ABOUT, conceptually what God wants us to understand. God wants us to move over to the other side. But we need more than just to know about this or agree with it. We have to act on it. John 3:16 says, "For God so loved the world, that he gave his only Son, that whoever believes in him should not perish but have eternal life."

B Write "John 3:16 - Believe" on top of the cross, left side.

C John 1:12 says, "But to all who did receive him, who believed in his name, he gave the right to become children of God."

D Write "John 1:12 – Receive" on top of the cross, right side.

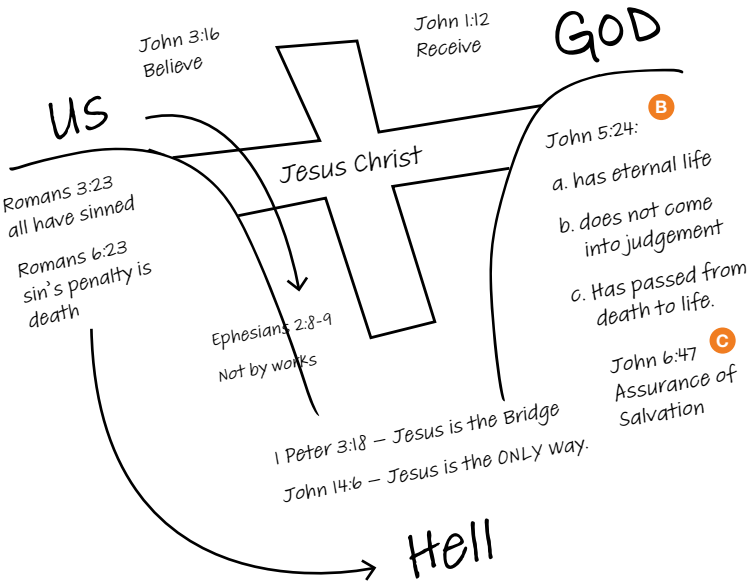
E Believing and Receiving means <u>trusting Jesus Christ alone for your Salvation</u>. It means <u>asking Jesus Christ to come in to forgive us and to take control of our lives</u>.



Step 7

Ⓐ **WHEN WE TRANSFER TO JESUS ALONE OUR COMPLETE TRUST, He promises to do these three things for us: John 5:24 says, "Truly, truly, I say to you, whoever hears my word and believes him who sent me has eternal life. He does not come into judgment, but has passed from death to life."**

Ⓑ Write on the side of God "John 5:24:
a. has eternal life;
b. does not come into judgement;
c. has passed from death to life.



Step 8

(Clarification Question)
DOES THIS MAKE SENSE TO YOU?

You know, I was ____ [your age] **when I came to this decision in my life. I knew I was a sinner and needed a Savior. I learned that Jesus had paid for my sins on the cross. It was then that I prayed a prayer like this. I told the Lord:**

- **"Lord, I know I am a sinner.** [Confess]
- **But I believe that Jesus died on the cross for my sin.** [Believe]
- **I now put my trust in Jesus Christ alone for my salvation.** [Transfer Trust]
- **I ask you to come into my life right now, forgive me, and give me eternal life.** [Receive]
- **Please take control of my life and help me be the person you want me to be."** [Repent]

(Application Question) **Would you like to 'move over the bridge' today by trusting Jesus Christ for your salvation?** (Wait for the answer)

We can tell the Lord that by praying a prayer as I did.

REVIEW KEY TRUTHS

First, let's clarify what this means:

- **"Do you know that you are a sinner?"**
- **"Do you know that your sin separates you from God?"**
- **"Do you believe Jesus paid for our sins in full on the Cross?"**
- **"Do you now want to turn from your sin and trust in Jesus to save you?"**

(Decision Question **Would you like to pray right now?"**

[If s/he is ready…] **I can lead us in prayer. Follow after me…** (See above prayer)

Step 9

[After the prayer…]

CONGRATULATIONS! Now you're a child of God and assured of eternal life.

When doubts creep in, always remember this promise in John 6:47:

"Truly, truly, I say to you, whoever believes has eternal life"

Who is speaking here? – Jesus.

He is God, and He's the one who died for you so that you will have eternal life. He won't lie to you.

Ⓒ Write "John 6:47 – Assurance of Salvation" on the side of God under John 5:24.

UNION CHURCH OF MANILA

God's Story:
A Gospel-Sharing Tool